Heavy Menstrual Cycles

Abnormal Uterine Bleeding (AUB) — Understanding Your Options for Relief

🔍 WHAT IS AUB?

- Bleeding that is unusually **heavy, prolonged, or irregular**
- Very common — affects millions of women
- Can significantly impact daily life and quality of life
- May signal underlying health conditions that need treatment

COMMON CAUSES

- Hormonal imbalances 🔄
- Uterine fibroids or polyps
- Endometrial hyperplasia or carcinoma
- Adenomyosis (uterine thickening)

💡 Accurate diagnosis is crucial before choosing treatment — your doctor may recommend blood tests, ultrasound, or endometrial biopsy.

💊 MEDICAL TREATMENTS

HORMONAL OPTIONS

- ✓ COCs — Combined oral contraceptives — regulate cycles & reduce bleeding
- ✓ Progestin-Only Pills — For women who cannot take estrogen
- ✓ LNG-IUD — Hormonal IUD — local hormone to thin lining
- Rx — GnRH Agonists — induce temporary menopause-like state
- Rx — Danazol — suppresses endometrial growth

NON-HORMONAL OPTIONS

- Rx — **Tranexamic Acid** — reduces bleeding by stabilizing clots
- OTC — **NSAIDs** (ibuprofen) — reduces bleeding and pain
- OTC — **Iron supplements** — essential if anemia present

🔪 SURGICAL TREATMENTS

- **Endometrial Ablation** — destroys uterine lining to reduce/stop bleeding — Minimally Invasive
- **Hysteroscopic Polypectomy** — removes polyps causing bleeding
- **Myomectomy** — removes fibroids, preserves uterus — Fertility-Sparing
- **Laparoscopic Myomectomy** — minimally invasive fibroid removal
- **Uterine Artery Embolization (UAE)** — blocks blood supply to fibroids
- **Hysterectomy** — definitive solution; ends fertility — Permanent

⚕ *Choice depends on age, fertility goals, fibroid type, and severity of symptoms.*

🌿 LIFESTYLE & SPECIAL CONSIDERATIONS

LIFESTYLE STRATEGIES

- 🏃 Regular exercise helps regulate cycles and reduce symptoms
- 🥗 Healthy, balanced diet — especially iron-rich foods
- 🧘 Stress management — stress worsens hormonal imbalance
- 📅 Keep regular gynecological exam appointments

TREATMENT SELECTION FACTORS

- 🍼 Fertility goals — determines conservative vs. definitive approach
- ⚖️ Comorbidities — obesity, hypertension, clotting disorders matter
- 📊 Symptom severity — guides aggressiveness of approach

🚨 Seek Immediate Help If:

- Soaking >1 pad/hour for several hours
- Passing clots larger than a quarter
- Dizziness, fainting, or severe pain

💬 **Every woman's experience with heavy bleeding is unique. Your treatment plan will be personalized to your specific needs, goals, and health history. Bring your questions — we're here to help you find relief and improve your quality of life.** 💪